

IN THE DISTRICT COURT OF APPEAL OF THE STATE OF FLORIDA
SECOND DISTRICT

IN RE: THE MARRIAGE OF

SARAH HANSON,

Petitioner/Appellee/Wife, and

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,

Respondent/Appellant/Husband.

Case No.: 2D2025-1936

Lower Tribunal No.: 24-DR-001150

REPLY BRIEF OF APPELLANT

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PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. Throughout this Reply Brief, Appellee shall be referred to as Wife or Appellee, and Appellant shall be referred to as Husband or Appellant. Citations to the appendices and briefs filed in this appeal are abbreviated as follows: (IBA): Initial Brief Appendix filed by Appellant; (AB): Answer Brief filed by Appellee/Wife; (SBA): Supplemental Appendix filed by Appellant, (MSR): Documents filed with this Court as part of the Motion to Supplement on 9-24-25. All citations refer to the record as submitted in these appendices unless otherwise noted.
2. Appellant recognizes the gravity of the substantiated allegations of misconduct and the direct tone employed herein. These concerns stem from documented ethical violations and systemic failures and refusals in the 13th Judicial Circuit, to see the simple truth of what Mr. Davis, Judge Ayers, and others have done.
3. The repeated failures to enforce discovery obligations and address misconduct continue to harm this family, yet the 13th Circuit actors continue to protect those guilty of misconduct while letting the victims, including children, suffer.
4. The “club house culture in the 13th Circuit Family Law division has gone too far, and given that the local judges will not protect citizens from their fellow “club members,” transfer is imperative.
5. Attempts to cover up Davis’s misconduct so deserving of bar action and other consequences now involve the Florida bar, making the direct tone even more critical. As confirmed by correspondence (SBA, pp. 86-107), the bar violated its own rules in handling the complaint refusing to offer any transparency nor accept any assistance.

6. Appellant urges careful review to ensure accountability and a step toward repairing public trust in the judiciary.

I. CORRECTIONS TO THE FACTS INCLUDING MISREPRESENTATIONS IN ANSWER BRIEF

7. Wife's Answer Brief (AB. 2–4) relies on demonstrably false, unsupported conclusory allegations where she is even able to offer any citation to the record.

8. These allegations contradict the record and law, ignoring documented instances of concealment and obstruction spanning now, a year and a half.

9. The case's posture reflects deep systemic bias in the 13th Circuit Family Law Division (13th Circuit). (SBA. pp. 53-61; SBA. pp. 62-75).

10. Relationships control results over the facts and the law, seemingly, with no end, as evidenced by the trial court's consistent refusal to address the core issue, ethical complaints against Mr. Davis related to his efforts to obstruct the core issue (IBA. pp. 854–859), with now a third level of corruption obstructing Husband's access to the videotape evidence of active bias during a hearing, (Please see MSR filed 9-24-25)

11. Every action Wife and Mr. Davis have taken the past year and a half 1) intentionally delays, harasses, or otherwise obstructs Husband's sole objective: discovery into concealed marital assets, which Wife admitted failing to disclose during the execution of the post-nuptial agreement (IBA. pp. 1122–1125, 1569-1618) and 2) there is no basis in the facts and law to support any need for the actions.

12. The 13th Circuit has operated as more of a club house than a court house.

13. It prioritizes personal connections over truth and law, as seen in the handling of disqualification motions and discovery enforcement (IBA. pp. 325–338; IBA. pp. 777–804).

14. Prioritizing relationships over the facts and law (or simply corruption) blocks public access to justice in violation of state and Federal constitutional rights.

15. The following reflects the various corrupt and dishonest actions Wife, Mr. Davis, and Judge Ayers pursued, that build on the initial concealment:

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Actor	Misconduct	Evidentiary support
Wife	Concealed marital assets	"Wife's refusal to disclose financials" (IB. pp. 1122–1125)
	Baselessly weaponized custody to block discovery	"Use of custody issues to avoid discovery" (SBA. p. 35-48)
	Pursued 1.5 years of litigation all to derail discovery	"No factual allegations of an actual emergency" (SBA. PP 1-34.)
	Refused to produce records after stipulating to do so	"Stipulated to produce records by June 28, 2024 — did nothing" (IB. pp. 1392–1395)
Mr. Davis	Helped Wife conceal evidence	"Strategically trickled out documents" (IB. pp. 22–25)
	Misrepresented compliance with discovery	"Sneakily worded certificate of compliance" (IBA. 1569-1618)
	Filed retaliatory motions timed to harass Husband	"December 13 motion filed to derail pending discovery" (IB. pp. 1176–1219)
	Made dishonest statements impacting children	"Accused Husband of gamesmanship despite offering alternate dates" (SBA. Exhibit E)
Judge Ayers	Silenced objections to Davis's discovery violations	"Refused to address discovery obstruction and ethical violations" (IB. pp. 854–859)
	Showed open bias against Husband	"Lied on the record, refused to produce courthouse video" (SBA. Pp.76-83)
	Tried to impose GAL despite lack of evidence	"Impossible to draft an order supporting it" (IB. pp. 1402–1405)
Husband	Requested discovery into concealed assets	"Husband's May 2024 filing seeking financial transparency" (IB. pp. 22–25)
	Sought to minimize harm to children	"Offered alternate hearing dates and signed releases" (SBA. 35-48)

16. The core of all of the concealment efforts are financial documents – some of which Wife, (non-disclosing party for post marital agreement) demanded and received the equivalent of

Husband (the disclosing party for same PMA), yet she refuses to reciprocate. (IBA. pp. 844-847; IBA. pp. 1415-1416)

17. Wife and Mr. Davis have objected to and refused to respond to every single effort Husband has made to get records, failing to even properly comply with mandatory disclosures, an issue that remains pending before this Court.

18. Wife specifically misstates the issue on appeal, taking it to the illogical extreme as suggested in her Answer Brief at p. 3: “Appellant maintains the basis for the venue change is ‘corruption’ within the entirety of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit to include his own attorneys retained.” (Emphasis added).

19. Wife suggests the legal standard for Husband to prevail is a showing that every person employed at the 13th Circuit from janitors to Judges is corrupt.

20. It’s quite telling that Wife extrapolates the precise issue for this Court to the absurd; a tacit admission that there’s a massive amount of evidence to demonstrate corruption involving the actors in this case, “but not the entire circuit...”

21. Wife's credibility is undermined by concealment.

22. She refuses to void the PMA (IBA. p. 221), which would, if she’s been honest and has nothing to hide, would provide her a windfall if she’d simply agree.

23. She then misrepresents the facts again in her appellate brief suggesting there’s no evidence of the windfall she’d receive if she agreed to waive discovery objections in exchange for voiding the PMA. The parties financial documents are cited as part of the record and demonstrate that if that’s the proper total, as wife claims, she’d be entitled to significantly more money.

24. If she'd agree to void the PMA, Wife would net over \$100,000 in additional assets assuming her disclosures were honest and absent any other significant change.
25. Wife could agree to waive discovery and gain access to in excess of \$100,000, while shutting down most of the litigation, if she would simply allow Husband the opportunity to investigate these marital assets.
26. Her refusal is tantamount to a confession.
27. Judge Ayers failed to enforce orders, repeatedly silencing Husband's pleas to focus on the core discovery problem while covering up for objections to Davis's violations (IBA. pp. 854–859).
28. The 13th Circuit continues in its failures to address the corruption, while still entertaining motions meant only to disrupt and harass.
29. Judicial bias causing unnecessary damage to a family requires transfer under Fla. Stat. § 47.122. See Caperton v. A.T. Massey Coal Co., 556 U.S. 868, 876 (2009) (requiring recusal where bias probability is too high).
30. Disqualification alone does not cure systemic issues, as the pattern of protection among circuit actors persists.
31. The 13th Circuit has shirked its responsibility to address misconduct.
32. A fair outcome is impossible, as demonstrated by the trial court's action in support and covering up obvious ethical violations despite multiple filings (IBA. pp. 854–859; IBA. pp. 1402–1405).

II. ARGUMENT

33. The standard of review for venue transfer denial under Fla. Stat. § 47.122 is abuse of discretion, although De novo review should apply on the constitutional violations described in detail throughout especially given how much corruption impacted the proceedings below.
34. Here, denial of venue transfer is an extreme abuse of discretion. The conduct of the 13th Circuit actors is an elephant stampede over Husband and his due process rights, as the trial court failed to address evidence of systemic favoritism (IBA. pp. 854–859). Fla. Const. Art. I, § 9; U.S. Const. Amend. XIV. The transfer denial implicates Husband's right to an impartial tribunal.
35. § 47.122's "interest of justice" prong, distinct from convenience, requires transfer amid bias, where the record shows repeated procedural irregularities favoring Wife (IBA. pp. 1176–1219). *Caperton*, 556 U.S. at 876; *Livingston*, 441 So. 2d at 1087.

A. CLARIFICATION OF CORRUPTION ALLEGATIONS AND WIFE'S RELIANCE ON DOUBLE HEARSAY

36. Wife dismisses bias claims as "self-serving" (AB. 4), ignoring massive irregularities, such as the rushed handling of attorney withdrawals without scrutiny for grounds to withdraw which should and would have revealed the corruption active within the 13th Circuit (IBA. pp. 854–859; IBA. p. 387). Judge Ayers, and now Felix seem intent on preventing that. (IBA, pp.93-111, transcript of October 9, 2025 hearing to be provided)
37. Wife relies on double hearsay falsely citing “a barrage of emails” from Husband, (AB. 5) that attorney, Mr. Hodz described trying to justify the unjustifiable – Mrs. Hodz withdrawing without doing the one objective she was hired to accomplish, based on one phone call with Mr. Davis. (1-21-25 hearing ,IBA, pp. 898-941)

38. While Mr. Hodz suggested there were many inappropriate emails from Husband, no threatening or even inappropriate emails were ever produced, despite opportunities in hearings and filings. *Id.*
39. The January 9, 2025 transcript (AIB. p. 387, 876-897, and, 1028-1051) demonstrates Ms. Hodz's withdrawal was granted without substantiation, allowing avoidance of discovery obligations.
40. Ms. Hodz's withdrawal served to help Mr. Davis and Wife continue the concealment, even though it was directly detrimental to her client and the sole objective for which she was hired and agreed to accomplish. (IBA. p. 387)
41. It aligns with Davis's threats (IBA. pp. 777–804) and *Bainter v. League of Women Voters of Fla., 150 So. 3d 1115, 1120 (Fla. 2014)* (condemning obstructive tactics in discovery).
42. Wife's child concerns (AB. 6) are contradicted by delays and concealment going back even before signing the PMA.
43. She weaponizes custody (SBA. Exhibit C), filing baseless motions without evidence of harm to the children.
44. This prejudices due process and requires transfer to Pasco serves justice.
45. Under the required analysis for *Mathews v. Eldridge, 424 U.S. 319, 335 (1976)* balances state and private interests here although no one has identified a state interest in keeping the case in Hillsborough under these circumstances.
46. Protecting corrupt attorneys and judges is the only interest served by forcing the parties to remain in Hillsborough, obviously against public interest. (IBA. pp. 777–804; IBA. pp. 1392–1395).

47. Wife still has offered no valid explanation for refusing to agree to a more convenient venue as the delay explanation is absurd given that she'll be waiting on a constitutional appeal.
48. Noting that Wife could end this litigation by agreeing to reciprocal discovery to what she makes the reality of the current situation and the required result crystal clear – get the family away from the corruption so that they may begin healing and salvaging a coparenting relationship.

B. RESPONSE TO SELF-SERVING CONCLUSORY STATEMENTS AND CASE LAW WIFE IMPROPERLY CITES FOR SUPPORT

49. Wife claims no basis for transfer (AB. 10), because she's actively benefited from the very grounds that require transfer, judicial complicity and even advancement of her continuing efforts to conceal evidence of marital assets, under truly outrageous circumstances.
50. She, quite self-delusionally ignores (while benefitting from) massive judicially supported unlawful obstruction and corruption (IBA. pp. 854–859; IBA. pp. 1176–1219), including the strategic timing of motions to coincide with the date when Ayers, Hodz, and Davis conspired to take his attorney away on a single day's notice.
51. Wife improperly relies on McGee v. McGee, 145 So. 3d 955 (Fla. 1st DCA 2014), and Vitale v. Vitale, 994 So. 2d 1242 (Fla. 4th DCA 2008). The cases are completely irrelevant to the present case based on the obvious difference of the massive, uninterrupted, unchecked, harmful dangerous corruption that's infected everything about the present case.
52. It's no surprise that the corrupt would like to ignore the massive corrupt elephant in the room. But it's still here causing chaos on a family as the 13th Circuit actors continue to conspire to suppress the truth and much needed consequences.

53. Failure to make bias findings prejudices review and demonstrates the fact that all of the 13th

Circuit actors are well aware of the truth. They just believe ignoring it and getting others to

sweep it under the rug is the way to handle it. Reeves v. Fleetwood Homes of Fla., Inc., 889

So. 2d 812, 822 (Fla. 2004) (requiring specific findings for meaningful appellate review).

54. Disqualification (IBA. pp. 325–338) does not cure institutional bias. *Goedmakers v.*

Goedmakers, 520 So. 2d 575, 579 (Fla. 1988) states fairness outweighs rigid venue,

emphasizing that transitory actions like divorce allow flexibility for justice.

III. REBUTTAL OF WIFE’S CLAIMS ON JUDICIAL CORRUPTION, PROCEDURAL HISTORY AND DELAY CLAIMS

55. Wife's delays are clear and intentional. She ignored the June 28, 2024 stipulation (IBA. pp.

1392–1395), providing no records despite agreement.

56. She shifted custody positions in October 2024 (SBA. Exhibit C), with no basis in fact for

doing so, raising unsubstantiated allegations to divert from financial issues.

57. When that didn’t deter Husband’s discovery, she filed 4 baseless December 13 motions

(IBA. pp. 1176–1219), timed to harass and delay discovery hearings. (IBA, pp.297-315)

58. Escalations in weaponing the children have consistently coincided with Husband's refusal to

abandon discovery efforts. With Wife’s history of violence towards Husband and the

severity of the misconduct and fraud, and attempts to cover it up, it’s important that the Court

act quickly to protect Husband from being permanently silenced.

59. Judge Ayers confirmed Mr. Davis runs her courtroom, when she excused Davis from

documenting a basis for his GAL motion, when Husband already filed a motion to strike the

GAL based on Davis's noncompliance and complete inability to draft any support for a GAL.

(IBA. pp. 1052– 1121),

60. Despite Husband's formal motion and insisting on Davis providing his summary before the excusal, Ayers still allowed him to avoid scrutiny of the unsupported GAL position.
61. This supports § 47.122 transfer for justice. *Guntner v. Jennings*, 980 So. 2d 1185, 1187 (Fla. 5th DCA 2008) (transfer appropriate to ensure fair proceedings).
62. Judge Felix confirmed that he's more concerned with relationships over seeing the obvious truth in this case in denying Husband's motion for emergency relief, focused on the core problem. (IBA pp.93-111).
63. *Goedmakers* and *Caperton*, require transfer based on the appearance of unfairness despite the trial Court's refusal to make findings of fact regarding the misconduct. Transfer to Pasco is necessary and lawful under these circumstances given the severity of the corruption Husband has suffered in the 13th Circuit.

IV. JUDICIAL OVERSIGHT FAILURES

64. This Court is well aware of 13th Circuit leadership actively concealing evidence of in-house corruption, even refusing to provide the video evidence Ayers offered during the April 4, 2025 hearing. MSR, pp. 1-50).
65. The 13th Circuit's Leadership and the bar that practices before it have circled their wagons in quite a disturbing way as explained further in Husband's motion to supplement the record, filed in this matter on September 24, 2025. Husband reasserts and incorporates the facts, arguments, and evidence associated with the motion to supplement herein to support transfer to Pasco County.
66. Again, Wife's opposition to the Court turning over evidence of its own bias is obvious.

67. It further demonstrates how the bench and Wife/Mr. Davis are working as a team now – trying to bury one another’s misconduct, still to the ongoing detriment of Husband and the children, in clear and obvious violation of constitutional rights.
68. The chief Judge has done nothing to remedy the problem despite being advised of these concerns as of February 12, 2025 correspondence describing Ayers’ handling of this case and history including self-funding her campaign and using a name other than the one she used to practiced law.
69. Ongoing issues persist with Wife filing more harassing litigation right as this reply brief became due reminiscent of the sudden attack of 4 motions (after no motions whatsoever were filed by Wife the first several months) just as the club members organized snatching my attorney out from under me, before she did what she agreed to do. (SBA, pp. 1-48, 62-75).
70. Wife's counsel scheduled the October 9 hearing unilaterally despite the active stay and no attempt whatsoever to describe any emergency. (SBA, 1-48),
71. In doing so, he misrepresented coordination efforts twice. Id.
72. Baseless fees motion followed (SBA. 1-34), accusing Husband of gamesmanship despite his offers of alternative dates, within the timeframe demanded by Davis.
73. No emergency exists (SBA, pp. 1-48) as confirmed by lack of factual allegations and recent parent-teacher conferences showing no concerns.
74. Perhaps the most concerning recent development is that the Florida Bar dismissed the bar complaint on Mr. Davis, while violating its own rules, without any findings, or even any evidence suggesting that Husband’s description of serious, credible, and harmful violations is anything less than perfectly accurate. (SBA, pp. 86-107).
75. This violates procedural transparency and the basic purpose of the Florida bar.

76. While Husband is very concerned about having to state this so openly against the bar with authority over his livelihood, there is corruption in the bar that's harming Florida citizens, and requires investigation, as one can plainly see from the intentional ignorance in relation to plain obvious violations. SBA, pp. 86-107.
77. The Florida Bar is concealing evidence related to a purported investigation, relying on 2 attorneys, Allie Huston and Alicia Gangi's dismissal of the complaint with nothing suggesting that they have any understanding of the facts whatsoever, all while each refused pleas and offers from Husband to assist in providing irrefutable evidence of severe, harmful misconduct. P. 86-107 SBA).
78. It seems like the Florida bar is operating in that same clubhouse culture, where certain lawyers will just not be disciplined or even investigated because of relationships, irrespective of how dishonest, unethical and harmful their conduct is. Id.
79. The Florida bar failed to contact Husband regarding anything on the investigation despite Husband's diligent and good faith offers to help.
80. There's no excuse or explanation for failing to hold Davis is accountable which is why the bar remains silent, providing need for further investigation and consequences in order to protect the public.

VI. CONCLUSION

81. In response to Husband's sole objective, investigating concealed martial assets at a very painful time, Wife, Mr. Davis and the 13th Circuit have colluded with one another, leveraging the clubhouse contacts and culture, to thwart that sole good faith objective, using Husband's candor to label him inaccurately while refusing his offers to sign releases, attend

evaluations, void the PMA (that currently protects Husband), etc. simply to convince Wife to waive the discovery efforts.

82. It's Wife who refuses to allow this case to move forward due to one simple dispute –

Husband desperately wants answers to what happened to marital assets and how badly he was defrauded, while Wife wants to perpetuate and perfect the fraud.

83. The 13th Circuit has revealed its priorities – protecting fellow club members.

84. Husband's position has not changed since May of 2024 and will not change.

85. Wife's Answer Brief fails to refute the evidence of procedural abuse, bias, and judicially

enabled obstruction of evidence, offering only weak objections, i.e. "it's not the "entire" 13th Circuit that's revealed itself as corrupt..." AB. p. 3

86. The facts demonstrate an inconvenient truth for Mr. Davis, the 13th Circuit, and the Florida

Bar: a system prioritizing relationships over truth and the children's right to a fair process.

87. The trial court's order misapplies § 47.122 and disregards constitutional safeguards under

Caperton v. A.T. Massey Coal Co., 556 U.S. 868 (2009), *Mathews v. Eldridge*, 424 U.S. 319 (1976), and *Goedmakers v. Goedmakers*, 520 So. 2d 575 (Fla. 1988).

88. The interest of justice requires transfer to Pasco County, where Wife resides, to restore

fairness and protect due process and the children's welfare. Given the abdication of ethical

rules and entitlement to ignore facts and law in favor of protecting insiders, further

investigations and consequences beyond transfer are imperative to address systemic

corruption in the 13th Circuit (SBA. pp. 86-107; SBA. pp. 108-116)

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing has been furnished via the Florida Courts e-Filing Portal to Sarah S. Hanson, Esq., FBN 065956, sahanson@aainsco.com, on this 10th day of October, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Hanson
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Certificate of Compliance

I certify that this brief complies with the font requirements of Florida Rule of Appellate Procedure 9.210(a)(1) (12-point Times New Roman or Arial, double-spaced) and does not exceed the 15-page limit under Rule 9.210(a)(2), excluding exempted sections.

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